

# Solving Polynomial Equations Modulo a Prime

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1. Let  $p$  be a prime number.
  - (a) Find all solutions to  $x^2 \equiv 1 \pmod{p}$ .
  - (b) For which primes  $p$  does  $x^2 \equiv -1 \pmod{p}$  have a solution?
  - (c) How many solutions does  $x^2 \equiv a \pmod{p}$  have for a given  $a \not\equiv 0 \pmod{p}$ ?
2. Find all solutions to  $x^3 + x + 1 \equiv 0 \pmod{5}$ .
3. Let  $f(x) \in \mathbb{Z}[x]$  be a polynomial of degree  $d$ . Show that  $f(x) \equiv 0 \pmod{p}$  has at most  $d$  solutions modulo  $p$ .